Call accounting. One *call* is one request to a generation API, whatever its length. It can go to the model under test, the paraphrase generator, or the judge. Calls are counted per case at evaluation time; the budget k is the batch mean. Everything replayed from the cache is free.

Table 1: A. What is and is not a call.

Item	Sent to	Calls	Charged to	Note
Counted				
Paraphrase generation	generator	1 per case	paraphrase-based policies	Once, before the screen. Same-prompt baselines do not pay it.
Draw	model under test	1 each	all methods	One response: answer, rationale and verbalized confidence. Original wording and paraphrase draws cost the same.
Probe (negation, relabel, distractor)	model under test	1 each	CEL	Fixed templates, so no generation call. Survivors of the screen only.
Challenge	model under test	1	CEL	Survivors only.
Rationale-entropy grouping	judge	1 per case	CEL, semantic entropy	One call groups all rationales of a case. Needs at least 2 draws.
Separate verbal call	model under test	1	CEL	Only if `verbal_per_draw` is off.
Not counted				
Verbalized confidence on a draw	–	0	–	Rides on the draw's response (main configuration).
Text signals, first-token probability	–	0	–	Read from the same responses.
Local NLI judge	–	0	–	No API call. An API judge would count as 1.
Held-out probe	–	0	–	Audit only; never used in selection.
Cache replay and subsampling	–	0	–	Baselines, ablations and budget curves re-score the cache.

Table 2: B. Calls per case by method at budget k. A dash means the method does not use that item.

Method	Generator call	Draws	Judge call	Probes, challenge	**Total**	Note
Random	–	1	–	–	**1**	Order is random; the draw only supplies an answer.
Verbalized confidence	–	1	–	–	**1**	
Self-consistency (+ verbal)	–	k	–	–	k	
Semantic entropy	–	$k-1$	1	–	k	
BSDetector	–	$k-1$	–	–	$k-1$	c_1 replaces the reflection call.
Avg-Conf, self-random	–	k	–	–	k	
Avg-Conf, prompting	1	$k-1$	–	–	k	
CISC	–	k	–	–	k	
Black-box calibrator	1 if $k \geq 5$	k or $k-1$	–	–	k	k draws below 5; from 5, $k-1$ draws split between original wording and paraphrases.
CEL-k (allocation a)	1	k_1 + extra	1 if SE	flips + challenge	$\bar{C}(a) \leq k$	Every case pays generator + k_1 draws; only survivors pay the rest.
Certified CEL	1	3 + more	1	probes + challenge	**4 or 15–16**	4 for eliminated cases; the rest depends on the signals used.